

Unit 1: Reading for Meaning

When we read, we do not just say the words. We think about what the words mean. This is called reading for meaning.

Read this short passage carefully.

Maria walked to school every morning. She lived far from the school and the walk took thirty minutes. On rainy days the path became muddy and slippery. She always wore her green raincoat and carried a yellow umbrella. Even on the hardest days Maria arrived at school with a smile.

Now answer these questions in your mind.

What is Maria's name? Maria.

Where was she walking to? School.

How long did the walk take? Thirty minutes.

What did Maria wear when it rained? A green raincoat.

What did she carry? A yellow umbrella.

How did Maria feel when she arrived? She was smiling.

Reading for meaning means finding answers inside the text. Good readers re-read if they do not understand. They slow down at difficult parts. They think about what they have read.

Here are some words from the passage. Muddy means covered in wet soil. Slippery means easy to slide on. Arrived means got to a place.

Knowing what words mean helps us understand what we read. When you find a word you do not know, try to use the other words around it to guess its meaning. This is called using context clues.

Practice reading every day. The more you read the better you understand.